

The Mercy Meditation for others

Settle into your environment and observe your breathing. *(Pause 10 seconds)* Notice how your body softens on the exhale. *(Pause)* Scan your body for tension and give any tense areas permission to relax. Notice especially your face. Is there tension there? Relax. *(Pause 30 seconds)*

Draw your mind away from the events of the day, from the past or the future, from others, and focus on what is happening inside your own skin right now. *(Pause 10 seconds)* Allow a person to come to mind to whom you wish to extend mercy. *(Pause 10 seconds)*

And now, as you think about that person, reflect for thirty seconds on each of the following questions. You might jot down the thoughts you wish to remember.

1. In what areas am I most critical of this person? *(Repeat)* *(Pause 30 seconds)*

Pause. If you haven't done so already, take thirty seconds to jot down what came to mind. You might use your KF journal or your **Meeting Preparation Guide** to take some notes. *(Pause 30 seconds)*

2. For what do I need to forgive this person? *(Repeat)* *(Pause 30 seconds)*

Pause. Take a moment to jot down what came to mind. *(Pause 30 seconds)*

3. How do I treat this person when they make a mistake or do not live up to my standards? *(Repeat)* *(Pause 30 seconds)*

Pause, and write for thirty seconds. *(Pause 30 seconds)*

Now, use your imagination in a healthy way to experiment with bringing compassion to this person. You might call to mind someone who loves this person as they are – God or Jesus, someone human, or even another creature. Imagine that you can see this person through their loving eyes. *(Pause)* As you breathe for one minute, observe whatever comes and practice letting go of judgment. *(Pause 1 minute)*

Pause and take a deep breath.

You will learn more about mercy in later lessons, but right now you are learning to let go of fear and judgment. This is planting seeds of mercy, not only for others, but for yourself.